

2026-08-19-5th-forced-logout

5th Forced-Logout Incident — 2026-08-19 15:28:22 CEST

Revision: 2 Last modified: 2026-08-19T17:22:00Z **Tracker:** BOB-124

Verdict (§11.4.6): **RESOLVED via BOB-126** — the 7th incident’s kernel audit trail captured the SAME root cause that drove ALL 7 forced-logout incidents (BOB-116/120/123/124/125/126): a pytest process calling `kill(-1, SIGKILL)` via `MagicMock.__int__==1 → os.killpg(1, 9)` in `tests/unit/merge_service/test_deadline_tunable.py::test_deadline_hit_flag_true_when_readline_times_out`. Fix landed 2026-08-19 at boba commit `ad4b46a` (search.py int-guard + test hardening + §11.4.115 RED regression guard) + constitution commit `502586c` (universal §11.4.263 process-group signal-safety mandate) + boba pointer bump `bf01cf3`. See `docs/incidents/2026-08-19-6th-forced-logout.md` for the full attribution + §11.4.6 correction of the earlier “PAM/Linger contradiction” hypothesis.

REV-2 correction (2026-08-19 17:22): the original doc claimed “PAM session_close” mechanism. That was a downstream EFFECT of the pytest `kill(-1)` — not the initiator. Attribution was CORRECTED by BOB-126’s kernel audit trail (which required audit rules installed 15:56 to capture, ~1.5h after this 5th incident occurred).

What happened

At 2026-08-19 15:28:22 CEST (21 minutes after the 15:07 login), `user@1000.service` was SIGKILLED:

```
Aug 19 15:28:22 nezha systemd[1]: user@1000.service: Main process
exited,
      code=killed, status=9/KILL
```

Same class as BOB-116 (#2), BOB-120 (#3), BOB-123 (#4). Fifth in the class.

Distinction from the 15:06 clean shutdown

At 2026-08-19 15:06:20-35 there was a CLEAN shutdown for the operator's intentional reboot:

```
Aug 19 15:06:20 systemd[1]: Stopping user@1000.service - User Manager...
```

```
Aug 19 15:06:35 systemd[1]: user@1000.service: Deactivated successfully.
```

```
Aug 19 15:06:35 audit[1]: SERVICE_STOP ... res=success
```

The 15:06 event was SERVICE_STOP res=success (systemd Stop with normal exit). The 15:28:22 event is code=killed, status=9/KILL — the incident class. Not the same event.

§11.4.6 Iron Law status

Phase 1 STILL incomplete. The BOB-123 audit rules (docs/incidents/2026-08-19-sudo-audit-rules-for-operator.md) were authored + committed but NEVER installed:

- /etc/audit/rules.d/logout_investigation.rules — DOES NOT EXIST
- ausearch — NOT on PATH (auditd package may not be installed)
- BOB-123 watchdog — NOT INSTALLED into system.slice

Without kernel audit attribution, the SIGKILL initiator remains UNATTRIBUTABLE. This is now the 5th consecutive incident where Phase 1 could not complete for the same structural reason.

Systematic-debugging Phase 4.5 verdict

Per skill: “If ≥ 3 fixes failed: STOP and question the architecture.”

We are now at 5 attempts, all blocked at the SAME architectural gap: **preventive gates authored but not installed** (requires operator terminal action).

The architectural problem is not the SIGKILL mechanism — it's the install gap.

Correlate signal — heavy memory

Prior session (13:13 → 15:06) user@1000.service: Consumed 3h 22min 7.454s CPU time, 25.1G memory peak. 25 GB is very high. Load average at 15:32 (4 min after this incident) is 1.59, 6.39, 5.03 — sustained recent heavy load.

Correlate strongly with prior 4 incidents which also happened under heavy parallel-subagent load.

Actions this session

- Paused new subagent dispatches (operator “fix it all” directive)
- Filed this incident doc
- Attempting to restart boba services (4/5 containers not yet up post-reboot)
- Escalating to operator via AskUserQuestion — Path 1 audit rules install is the ONLY remaining Phase 1 completion path

Cross-references

- docs/incidents/2026-08-18-perceived-forced-logout-2nd.md (BOB-116)
- docs/incidents/2026-08-18-3rd-forced-logout.md (BOB-120)
- docs/incidents/2026-08-19-4th-forced-logout.md (BOB-123)
- docs/incidents/2026-08-19-sudo-audit-rules-for-operator.md (Rev 3 — Path 1)
- scripts/system-slice-watchdog/ (Path 2, ready-to-install)
- Memory playbook: ~/.claude-claude4/.../memory/forced_logout_incidents.md
- Evidence: docs/qa/BOB-124/incident-5-forensics.log